The Care Leaders
Learning

Keynote workbook and resource

Tools for Schools

How to read the messages in children's behaviour, and have the tools to respond to them

Luke Rodgers BEM

This workbook belongs to

Date started



How to use this resource

Part workbook, part reference. Use it in the keynote, then keep it close: in your planner, in pastoral meetings, in your next staff training. Come back to it whenever a pupil puzzles you.



In the room

During the keynote. A few minutes each.



On your own

At home or at your desk, in the weeks after.



With your team

Staff meetings, INSET, pastoral and SEND teams.

Every activity follows the same path

Why What it is for

What good looks like Read the example

Your turn Write about your pupil

Done when How you know

Back to practice What you will do

Two more labels you will see



Learn

The theory. Read it once, then come back to it.



Tool to keep

Pages to photocopy, cut out or pin up in the staffroom.

Look after yourself. Some of this may bring up your own experiences. Take a break when you need one, and take anything heavy to your line manager or someone you trust.

Choose your pupil

Think of one pupil you are trying to support right now. Carry them through this resource. Use a made-up name and leave out anything that could identify them.

Made-up name

Age

How I know them, and why I chose them

Your facilitator

Luke Rodgers BEM brings a wealth of lived and professional experience to his work in children's services.

He founded The Care Leaders, a consultancy delivering transformation, training and leadership across children's social care, working with local authorities across England. He also founded the Care Leavers National Movement and has led engagement on the national rewrite of the Fostering Services National Minimum Standards.

Luke is a keynote speaker at conferences, schools and events across the UK. He is a former fellow of Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, and sat on the advisory board of the Rees Centre at the University of Oxford.

Follow me on LinkedIn

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Luke Rodgers BEM

Founder and CEO, The Care Leaders. From care leaver to care leader.

BEM

British Empire Medal, 2018 Birthday Honours, for commitment to children and families.

Gold

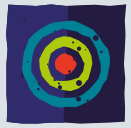
Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.

Winner

Workforce Development Award, Children & Young People Now Awards 2023.

What you will learn, and where you are starting

Four goals for the keynote. Rate yourself now, then again at the end.



1. Understand the impact of the language we use about children with a social worker.
2. Explain how attachment and trauma shape the nervous system.
3. See how school and children's social care clash, and who pays for it.
4. Use four practical tools with the pupils you teach.

Before you start: rate each statement

1 strongly disagree · 5 strongly agree

I understand how the words we use about pupils shape what happens to them.	1	2	3	4	5
I can explain how attachment and trauma affect the nervous system.	1	2	3	4	5
I can see where school and children's social care clash for a pupil.	1	2	3	4	5
I have practical tools I can use with a pupil this week.	1	2	3	4	5
I feel confident to act differently with the pupil I have in mind.	1	2	3	4	5

What's inside

Four parts. Story to notice, Theory to understand, Action to practise, Keep for the tools you will come back to.



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In the room

Start here: the lighter

A composite story. It draws on real experiences but is not one person. Read it, then answer as honestly as you can. Keep your answers. We come back to Jay on page 28.

Jay, 14

It's period four on a Wednesday and Jay's science class is lighting Bunsen burners for the first time. Jay has been in his foster home for six weeks and this is his third school in two years. He mostly keeps his head down.

Nobody can find the striker. While the group waits, Jay takes a lighter out of his blazer pocket and lights their burner. A couple of the others laugh.

Mr Hughes sees it from across the room. He goes red and points at the door. "Out. Now."

Ten minutes later he comes out, still angry. "Give me that. Where on earth did you get a lighter from?"

Jay looks at the floor. "It's my mum's," he says. Then, quietly, "I don't live with her any more. I'm in care."

Mr Hughes stops. Nobody had told him. His face changes completely. He hands the lighter back. "Just keep it in your bag, OK?"

The lighter wasn't his mum's. Jay got it from a friend.

You are Mr Hughes. Jay has just told you he is in care. What do you say next?

What happened to your anger when you read his answer?

What would you do with the lighter?

1



Story

Meet Sam. First you will read what is written about Sam. Then you will read Sam's story.

In this part

We inherit words	**8**
Sam's profile, and two scores	**9**
Sam's story, and the same two scores	**10**
I can't help, I want to help	**11**



In the room

We inherit words

What words do we use to describe children with a social worker? Somewhere, without meaning to, we store them. Then they start to do our thinking for us.

Challenging

"They are going to display challenging behaviour in my lessons."

High risk

"They are dangerous to be around."

Vulnerable

"They cannot look after themselves."

LAC and CIN

"They are lacking and in need."

Damaged

"They are broken."

The bigger problem: the expectation shapes what we do

They are broken → **They are unfixable** → **I don't have the skills** → **I can't help**

Which of these words have you heard, or used, in school this month?

Which "I can't help" thought is most familiar to you?

In the room

Meet Sam, 16

Everyone writes about Sam. A profile is a statutory document. It can go by different names, and it often arrives at school long before the young person does.

Sam's profile

Is at high risk of absconding.

Known to deal and has been caught with drugs at school.

Low attendance at school and is disengaged with other pupils.

Isolates themselves in their room. We are seeking psychological assessments as we think it links to early childhood trauma.

Struggles to follow simple house rules when living in a foster placement.

Persistent young offender with offences including burglary and affray.

Has stolen previous foster carer's car in the night.

Has issues with attachment.

Disruptive behaviour when confronted with authority, and their "outbursts" are hard to control.

Hard to build a rapport as can be guarded and "closed".

Pause

On your own, score these from 1 (low) to 10 (high). Hold your answers.

How confident would you be offering Sam a place in your school? **/10**

How concerned would you be about Sam? **/10**

In the room

Sam's profile, and Sam's story

The same events, read twice. On the left is what was written. On the right is what was actually happening.

What was written	What was happening
High risk of absconding	Was late home.
Burglary and affray	Took their own things from their parents' house without asking. Sam was attacked for it.
Known to deal	Smoked some weed with friends at school.
Stole a foster carer's car	Frightened and lonely, drove to see their mum. This happened once.
Low attendance, disengaged	Always being moved school. Just wants friends.
Issues with attachment	Struggles to feel safe with people.
Isolates in their room	When reminded of an abusive family, goes to their room and is often found crying.
"Outbursts" with authority	Lived where abuse was normal. Gets scared when they hear shouting.
Struggles with house rules	Has lived in so many places the rules keep changing.

Sam just wants to be loved.

Score again

Compare with page 9.

How confident would you be offering Sam a place in your school? /10

How concerned would you be about Sam? /10

What did you feel first when you read the profile?

In the room

“I can’t help” becomes “I want to help.”



What changes when the language changes

What “I can’t help” sounds like in school

- “I’ve got to think about all the other children in my school.”
- “It’s too high risk.”
- “Maybe a specialist setting would be better.”
- “It wouldn’t be the right place for Sam.”
- “I haven’t had the training for this.”

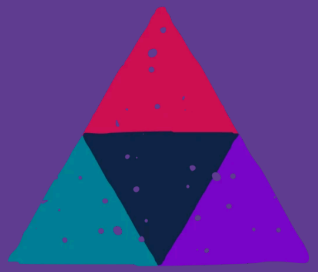
“I can’t help”

becomes

“I want to help.”

Did your scores move? What moved them?

2



Theory

Why the words stick, what Sam's brain learned to expect, and how school and social care clash.

In this part

Five biases in the file	**13**
Attachment and the brain	**15**
Two timetables	**18**
Who's who for a child in care	**20**
What the evidence shows	**21**

Learn

Five biases hiding in the file

Unconscious bias is the associations we hold, outside our conscious awareness and control. These five showed up in Sam's profile. They show up in every file, and in every staffroom conversation.

1
Age

Treating who they were at one age as who they are now.

Ask yourself
What has changed since this was written?

2
Gender

Boys read as risky, girls as vulnerable.

Ask yourself
Would I write it the same way about a girl, or a boy?

3
Anchor

The first thing you read frames everything after it.

Ask yourself
Did I meet them before I read about them?

4
Horns effect

One bad trait colours the whole picture.

Ask yourself
What are they good at?

5
Confirmation

New information gets fitted to the old story.

Ask yourself
What would prove me wrong?

Redundancy

We don't feel we have the skills to help.

Judgement

We wrongly judge young people.

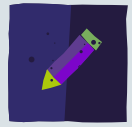
Rejection

Young people are rejected.

Which bias do you catch in yourself most?

On your own | With your team

Rewrite a pupil profile



So the first thing a new teacher reads about a pupil makes them want to say yes. Honest about what they need, and just as clear about who they are.

Written about Sam

Persistent young offender. Known to deal. Has stolen previous foster carer's car. Disruptive when confronted with authority. Hard to build a rapport.

What good looks like

Sam is 16 and loyal to their friends. Sam has moved home and school many times and wants to stay put. Sam gets scared when adults shout, and settles with time alone, then a calm adult who checks in. Sam wants friends, and to be loved.

Three checks for any pupil profile or handover note

1. Would they recognise themselves in it?
2. Does it say what helps, not only what goes wrong?
3. Would you be happy for them to read it at 18?

Your turn: your pupil, in their best light and honestly

Who they are

What they are good at

What has happened to them that staff need to know

What helps on a hard day in school

Done when. Every box is filled and all three checks are a yes.

Back to practice. Next time you write a handover note or speak about them in a meeting, start with who they are.

Learn

What Sam learned before 10



Sam's early years were shaped by three adults. A quick look at child development shows what that taught Sam. This draws on attachment theory, which began with John Bowlby's work on how early care shapes trust.

Mum

Non-nurturing

Dad

Neglectful and absent

Step-dad

Strict and abusive

0 to 4 years

Relationships with parents · first attachment style · wanting their attention · developing trust

> **"My parents don't love me. They are always fighting and when I cry no one comforts me."**

> **"I can't trust my parents. They don't keep me safe."**

> **"My dad hits my mum, and my mum doesn't seem to care about me."**

5 to 10 years

Developing logic · copying adults · learning good and bad · relationships with peers

> **"My parents shout at each other, so I should shout too."**

> **"Dad and step-dad are violent. That's what it means to be a man."**

> **"I will have relationships like the ones I have with my parents."**

What might your pupil have learned about adults before they met you?

Learn

The brain has two principles

It looks for patterns, and it is built to survive. For Sam, the threat might not be a snarling dog. It might be a relationship, or a raised voice in a corridor.

1 · Pattern seeking

The brain sorts the world into familiar and unfamiliar. When a teacher tries to comfort Sam, the brain may read it as a threat, because relationships in the past were threatening. We call this a red flag.

Adults: logical, regulated

Call a friend
Communicate boundaries
Sit with the emotion

Children: emotive, unregulated

Become triggered
Push people away
Panic

2 · Survival orientated

When we are scared, the brain goes into survival mode. Walter Cannon described fight or flight in his 1915 research on the body's response to fear. We now talk about five responses. Freeze, flop and fawn were added later, and the therapist Pete Walker named the fawn response in his work on complex trauma.

Fight **Flight** **Freeze** **Flop** **Fawn**

"Connections on the outside build connections on the inside."
Dr Becky Bailey, Conscious Discipline

Learn | On your own



What you see in class, and what it might be

These responses are not choices. They are a body trying to stay safe. Knowing which one you are seeing helps you respond to the fear, not just the behaviour.

	What you might see in school	What it might be	What can help
Fight	Shouting, arguing, throwing a chair.	Fear, dressed as anger.	Calm first. Lower your voice. Talk later.
Flight	Walking out of class, hiding in the toilets, truanting.	Leaving before being let down.	Don't chase into conflict. Say where you will be.
Freeze	Going blank when asked a question in front of the class.	Overwhelmed, can't find words.	Stop the questions. Sit alongside.
Flop	"Whatever", head on the desk, falling asleep.	Armour against rejection.	Don't read it as disrespect. Stay warm.
Fawn	Pleasing, agreeing, "I'm fine, sir".	Keeping adults happy to stay safe.	Notice the "fine". Make it safe to say no.

"Might" matters. These are guesses to test, not a diagnosis, and they never cancel out a consequence.

Your turn: decode one behaviour

What I see

What it might be

What I will try

Learn

Two timetables

Sam lives on two timetables at once: school's and children's social care's. Only the headteacher and the designated teacher know Sam is in care. When the two clash, Sam pays.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Maths	PE	Science	Music	English
Late	**No PE kit**	**Missed lesson**	**Detention**	**Late again**
Seeing their social worker, or in a review meeting. School reads it as lateness.	Lost in an emergency move to a new foster home.	Trying to call a social worker who starts at 9, after school starts.	For homework not done, the night of a family visit.	An unsettled night after Thursday's family time.

Two common approaches. Mark your natural position.

Behaviourist
Sanction and reward, routine, discipline

Nurturist
Behaviour is communication, compassion, relationships

It is a spectrum. Most of us move along it depending on the day.

Sam says: "I don't want anyone to know I am in care."

Why might that be? What would you do?

On your own | With your team

Your two timetables planner

Map one week for your pupil: school above, social care below. Visits, reviews, family time, therapy, PEP meetings. Then circle the clashes.

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Weekend
School						
Social care						

Where do the two timetables clash? Who needs to know, and who will tell them?

Who's who. Turn the page for the people around a child in care, and what each one does.

Learn | On your own

Who's who for a child in care

Two systems, a lot of adults. Knowing who does what is the quickest way to stop the timetables clashing.

Designated teacher

Every maintained school and academy must have one, and it must be a qualified teacher or the head. They promote the education of pupils in care and previously in care, and lead on the PEP in school for pupils in care.

Virtual school head

Employed by the local authority to promote the education of the children it looks after, including those living out of area. Also offers advice on pupils previously in care.

PEP

The personal education plan, part of every child in care's care plan. The social worker starts it, and it is reviewed each term with the school, carer, virtual school and the young person.

Social worker

Responsible for the child's care plan. Schools often struggle to reach them during the school day.

Independent reviewing officer

Chairs the child's care reviews and checks the plan is working for them.

Foster carer or key worker

The adults the child lives with day to day, and often the best person to talk to about the week.

Who is the designated teacher in your school? Have you spoken to them this term?

Who could you ask about your pupil's PEP?

Learn

What the evidence does and does not show



Ideas from this keynote, and how firmly they stand. Use them as lenses, not labels.

Early relationships matter

The idea that early care shapes how children trust adults is well established, from Bowlby's attachment research onwards.

Strong

Attachment labels

Calling a child "attachment disordered" from their behaviour is not reliable. Only a qualified professional can assess that.

Use with care

Fight or flight

Described by Cannon in 1915 and well supported since. Freeze is also widely recognised.

Strong

Flop and fawn

Newer clinical descriptions. Useful language, with less research behind them.

Emerging

Bias training

Unconscious bias is real, but short training on its own rarely changes behaviour for long. The habits, like meeting before reading, matter more.

Mixed

The four tools

Developed by The Care Leaders from widely used approaches. Evidence-informed, not tested in a trial.

Practice framework

Which idea will you hold more loosely now?

Which idea do you want to read more about?

3



Action

Four tools you can use in school this week. Then back to Jay.

In this part

Tool 1: Just say yes	**23**
Tool 2: Spot, Soothe, Shift	**24**
Tool 3: Challenging stigma	**26**
Tool 4: Separating Reason from Behaviour	**27**

On your own | With your team

Tool 1: Just say yes

If we agree the words in Sam's profile are wrong, changing how we record is not enough. Sam is being turned away today: from a school place, a class, a club. So until the words change, we ignore them.

1

Ignore what is written

Meet the pupil, not the file.

2

End the cycle of rejection

Every no confirms what they already believe.

3

Just say yes

To the place, the class, the trip, the team.

Before you say no, ask yourself

- Have I met them, or only read about them?
- Which of the five biases might be doing my thinking?
- Do I know their story, or only their profile?
- What would need to be true for me to say yes?
- If I say no, who will say yes?

Your turn: a time you, or your school, said no. What would saying yes have taken?

Done when. You can name what a yes would have needed.

Back to practice. Next time a referral, a managed move or a trip list lands, meet before you decide.

Learn

Tool 2: Spot, Soothe, Shift

Being a safe adult, to help young people learn to trust. Spot and Soothe always come first. Then stop and decide which way to go.

They share something painful

In a lesson, at the door, in the corridor.

1

Spot

Notice and name the feeling. Let them finish. "It makes sense you feel this way."

2

Soothe

Slow down. Leave silences. Not "At least…". "I'm here. We can talk now, or later."

Then stop and decide

- Could they, or another child, be at risk of harm? **Yes, or not sure:** Signpost.
- Are they calm, heard and ready to hear a strength? **Not yet, or a loss:** stay with Soothe. **Yes:** Shift.



Signpost

Never reframe a disclosure. Be honest you can't keep it secret. Tell your designated safeguarding lead straight away.

Stay with Soothe

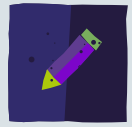
The default. Grief, loss and unfairness are real. "That's really unfair. I'm sorry."

Shift

Ask first, name one real strength, pause. "Can I tell you something I've noticed about you?" Pushed back? Go back to Spot.

Developed by The Care Leaders. First called Recognise, Reassure, Redefine. A practice framework: evidence-informed, not trial-tested.

On your own | With your team



Practise Spot, Soothe, Shift

Three composite moments in school. Write what you spot, how you would soothe, and which way you would go next.

What good looks like. Kai, 12, at the classroom door after a cancelled family visit: "Nobody ever turns up for me." Spot: "You were really looking forward to seeing her." Soothe: "I'm sorry. I'm here." Then: it's a loss, so stay with Soothe today. Shift another day.

Mia, 13

in registration, after family time last night

> **"She doesn't even care about me."**

What I spot

How I soothe

Signpost, stay, or shift?

Tyler, 15

in maths

> **"There's no point. I'll be moved again anyway."**

What I spot

How I soothe

Signpost, stay, or shift?

Ash, 11

at the end of the school day

> **"You'll get rid of me like the others did."**

What I spot

How I soothe

Signpost, stay, or shift?

On your own

Tool 3: Challenging stigma



When a pupil says they don't want teachers to know they have a social worker, it is usually because they expect to be judged. If we don't challenge that, we quietly agree they will be. Five steps.

1

Tell them they will not be judged

And if they ever feel they are, they come to you.

2

Explore both scenarios

What it looks like if teachers do know, and if they don't.

3

Involve them in the decision

Agree together what to say to teachers.

4

Don't take their first answer

Ask them to think about it for a couple of days.

5

Tell them you have their back

Whatever they decide.

Try saying

"Lots of young people feel like that. Can we think about what it would look like if your teachers knew, and if they didn't? You don't have to decide today."

Who in school knows about your pupil's care now?

Which step would you find hardest, and why?

Learn

Tool 4: Separating Reason from Behaviour

Holding pupils accountable in a way that gives them ownership to change. Respond to the reason first, then the behaviour. Both matter. Adapted from emotion coaching, which grew out of John Gottman's research on how parents respond to children's feelings.

Above the line: the behaviour, what you see — Later, calm and in private

The behaviour

Shouting, walking out, refusing to work. You see it first. You don't respond to it first.

3 Highlight the behaviour

"Feeling this way is OK. Behaving that way isn't."

4 Give ownership

"What can we do differently next time?"

Below the line: the reason, what you can't see — In the moment

What might be under the line

Tired, hungry, embarrassed, worried about home, struggling with a friend. You may never know.

1 Recognise the reason

"I can see something's not right for you today."

2 Offer support

"You don't have to talk now. I'll check in later."

Safety concern?

Stop at stage 2. Follow your safeguarding procedures and speak to your designated safeguarding lead straight away.

Avoid

- Personalising the system
- Excusing behaviour
- Worrying you'll get it wrong

Think of a behaviour in class that alarmed you. What might have been under the line?

In the room

Back to Jay

When a pupil says something personal that stops you in your tracks, your anger drops and the behaviour slips past. This is called alarm and disarm. Here is how Mr Hughes could have used Tool 4.

1 Recognise the reason
"Thanks for telling me. I wasn't aware."

2 Offer support
"I want you to know you can talk to me about this, or to our designated teacher. We want to make sure you have support."

3 Highlight the behaviour
"Lighters still aren't allowed in school."

4 Give ownership
"I'll keep it in my drawer. Come and see me at the end of the day and you can have it back, and we'll agree it stays at home."

What good looks like. Mr Hughes still holds the line on the lighter. Jay feels heard first, so he can hear the boundary. Nothing personal, no shame.

Your turn: look back at what you wrote on page 6. What would you change now?

Has a pupil ever alarmed and disarmed you? What happened?

With your team | On your own

Practise Tool 4



We are taught to deal with behaviour in two common ways: the behaviourist and the nurturer. Both can go wrong. Rewrite each one with the four stages.

Escalation nation

Event: Timmy is late for school.

Miss Trunchbull: "Why are you late?"
Timmy: "I don't know, miss."
Miss Trunchbull: "How can you not know? Detention."
Timmy: "Whatever. Chill out."

Rewrite it with the four stages

1
2
3
4

The "fine" line

Event: Dave forgets his homework.

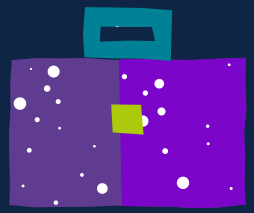
Mr Pan: "You didn't do your homework. Are you OK?"
Dave: "I'm fine."
Mr Pan: "You don't seem fine. You can speak to me."
Dave: "I'm fine!" **Mr Pan:** "OK, sorry."

Rewrite it with the four stages

1
2
3
4

On a hard day, are you more Trunchbull or Pan?

4



Keep

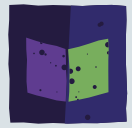
The tools and pages to come back to: in staff meetings, in pastoral conversations, and whenever a pupil puzzles you.

In this part

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Free online course	**39**

Tool to keep | With your team

Words that work



Much of the language in care was written for systems, not young people. They hear it in school, and later they read it in their files. Ask the pupil which words they prefer. Their answer wins.

Instead of	Try
Placement	**Home**
Contact	**Family time**
LAC	**Their name, or "a child in care"**
Absconded	**Left without telling us**
Refused to engage	**Didn't want to talk yet**
Kicked off	**Was overwhelmed**
Attention seeking	**Connection seeking**
Defiant	**Not ready yet**
Placement breakdown	**The move, or "it ended"**
LAC review	**My meeting**
Challenging	**Needs the most support**

Inspired by sector work on care language, including TACT's Language that Cares (2019).

The one word I will stop using from today

Words my pupil prefers

Add your own swaps for your school

On your own

What builds trust



For many young people in care, adults removed them, moved them and decided their lives in meetings they weren't in. Distrust is based on evidence. Trust comes back through predictability, not persuasion.

Rate yourself with your pupil

1 rarely · 5 always

I do what I said, when I said I would.	1	2	3	4	5
I explain decisions before they land, like a seating plan or a change of teacher.	1	2	3	4	5
I tell them what I am writing or saying about them.	1	2	3	4	5
I repair after a hard conversation.	1	2	3	4	5
I keep the same face, time and place where I can.	1	2	3	4	5

My lowest score, and why

One thing I will do to move it up by one

Done when. You have one specific thing to do, with a date.

Back to practice. Rate yourself again in a month.

On your own

After: where you are now, and your Monday plan

Rate the same five statements again, then make one plan.

1 strongly disagree · 5 strongly agree

I understand how the words we use about pupils shape what happens to them.	1	2	3	4	5
I can explain how attachment and trauma affect the nervous system.	1	2	3	4	5
I can see where school and children's social care clash for a pupil.	1	2	3	4	5
I have practical tools I can use with a pupil this week.	1	2	3	4	5
I feel confident to act differently with the pupil I have in mind.	1	2	3	4	5

What has changed, and why?

My Monday plan

One thing I will do in school

With which pupil, or which colleague

By when

How I will know it worked

The words written about a pupil shape whether anyone says yes to them.

Behaviour that looks like defiance is often a survival response. A safe adult can hold a boundary and still keep the pupil close.

Tool to keep

Quick reference cards

Cut along the dashes. Keep one in your planner, one on the staffroom board, one by your desk.

1 · Just say yes



Ignore what is written until it is right. End the cycle of rejection. Meet them before you decide.

2 · Spot, Soothe, Shift



Spot the feeling. Soothe: "I'm here." Signpost any disclosure. Stay with a loss. Shift only when ready.

3 · Challenging stigma



They won't be judged. Explore both scenarios. Decide together. Don't take the first answer. Have their back.

4 · Reason and behaviour



Now: recognise the reason, offer support. Later: highlight the behaviour, give ownership.

Five biases



Age · Gender · Anchor · Horns · Confirmation. Ask: what would prove me wrong?

Five survival responses



Fight · Flight · Freeze · Flop · Fawn. Respond to the fear, not just the behaviour.

On your own

Come back to this



Learning sticks when you return to it. Put three reminders in your diary now.

One week

Date

Did you do your Monday plan? What did your pupil notice?

One month

Date

Which tool have you used most? Rate yourself on trust again.

Three months

Date

Take the online course again. What do you notice now that you missed?

With your team

Run it with your team



Any page marked With your team works in a staff meeting, an INSET slot or a pastoral team meeting. The method is the same every time.

1
Choose one page
Twenty minutes is enough.

2
Write in silence
Everyone does Your turn on their own.

3
Share one line each
No discussion yet.

4
Agree one change
Write it in the plan below.

5
Check it next time
Ask about it at the next meeting.

Session	Page	Our change	Who checks
1	We inherit words, and Words that work		
2	Rewrite a pupil profile		
3	Two timetables and Who's who		
4	Practise Tool 4		

Tool to keep

Bring Tools for Schools to your whole staff

Everything in this workbook comes from Tools for Schools. We can deliver it for your school, your trust or your virtual school, so every adult a pupil meets responds in the same way.

Twilight training

A three-hour session for your whole staff team, built on story, theory and action.

Conference keynote

Up to 90 minutes at your conference or network event, with this workbook for every delegate.

Who it is for

Teachers, teaching assistants, pastoral staff, designated teachers and school leaders.

What it covers

The messages in children's behaviour, language and stigma, attachment and trauma, and where school and children's social care clash, with the four tools in this workbook.

Ask about Tools for Schools

Tell us about your school and when you would like it. We'll come back to you with dates and costs.

hello@thecareleaders.com

thecareleaders.com

Who in my school would I pass this to?

Learn

Where the ideas come from

If you want to go deeper, these are the sources behind the theory in this keynote.

Bowlby, J. (1969)
Attachment and Loss, Volume 1: Attachment.
Where attachment theory began.

Cannon, W. B. (1915)
Bodily Changes in Pain, Hunger, Fear and Rage.
The first description of fight or flight.

Walker, P. (2013)
Complex PTSD: From Surviving to Thriving.
Names the fawn response.

Bailey, B.
Conscious Discipline.
"Connections on the outside build connections on the inside."

Gottman, J. (1997)
Raising an Emotionally Intelligent Child.
The emotion coaching approach Tool 4 adapts.

Greene, R. (2008)
Lost at School.
Behaviour often signals a need, or a skill not yet learned.

Forscher, P. and others (2019)
A meta-analysis of procedures to change implicit measures. Journal of Personality and Social Psychology.
Why bias training alone has limited effect.

TACT (2019)
Language that Cares.
Changing the language of care, with children in care.

Department for Education (2018)
The designated teacher for looked-after and previously looked-after children; and Promoting the education of looked-after and previously looked-after children. Statutory guidance.
The roles of the designated teacher and virtual school head, and the PEP.

Tool to keep

Your free online course

A thank you for being in the room. Take Tools for Schools again at your own pace, and share it with colleagues who missed it.

Tools for Schools online

Hosted on our e-learning platform, The Care Leaders Online.

1. Go to thecareleadersonline.com/course/tools-for-schools-keynote
2. Create your free account
3. Enter your access code at checkout. The £20 price drops to £0.

TOOLSFORSCHOOLS

Free for 12 months from the day you enrol.

What is inside

1. **Impact of language**
   Meet Sam, unconscious bias, and Tool 1: Just say yes.
2. **Attachment and trauma**
   Sam's early years, the brain, and Tool 2: being a safe adult.
3. **Two timetables**
   How school and social care clash, and Tools 3 and 4.
4. **A certificate**
   Finish the course to claim your certificate of completion.

The Care Leaders
Learning

Keep learning with us

Tools for Schools online is free for 12 months with code **TOOLSFORSCHOOLS**, hosted on our e-learning platform, The Care Leaders Online.
thecareleadersonline.com/course/tools-for-schools-keynote

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